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Thin film transistor featuring variable thickness glue layer with tapered end

Abstract

A semiconductor device includes a substrate, a gate electrode, a gate dielectric layer, a channel layer, a source electrode and a drain electrode. The gate electrode is disposed over the substrate. The gate dielectric layer is disposed over the gate electrode. The channel layer is disposed over the gate dielectric layer. The source electrode and the drain electrode are disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode. In some embodiments, each of the source electrode and the drain electrode includes a glue layer and a metal pattern, and a thickness of the glue layer adjacent to a sidewall of the metal pattern is greater than a thickness of the glue layer adjacent to a bottom of the metal pattern.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Semiconductor devices are used in a variety of electronic applications, such as personal computers, cell phones, digital cameras, and other electronic equipment. Some semiconductor devices such as thin film transistors have attracted high attention due to the associated low cost, room temperature manufacturing process, high mobility for high speed operation, and the compatibility with transparent, flexible and light display applications. Although the existing semiconductor devices have generally been adequate for their intended purposes, they have not been entirely satisfactory in all respects.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIG. 1 to FIG. 6 illustrate cross-sectional views of forming a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 7 is a graph of sequence of pulses of different precursors in accordance with some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 8 to FIG. 10 illustrate cross-sectional views of various semiconductor devices in accordance with other embodiments.

(5) FIG. 11 illustrates a method of forming a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the invention. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

(7) Further, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

(8) The present disclosure is directed to semiconductor devices, and specifically to back/bottom gate semiconductor metal oxide transistor devices, which may be thin film transistor (TFT) devices and methods of forming the same. In the disclosure, the glue layers of source and drain electrodes are selectively formed on sidewalls of the source and drain electrodes, with the minimum amount (even zero) on bottoms of the source and drain electrodes, so as to reduce the contact resistance (R_c) delay and therefore improve the performance of the device.

(9) FIG. 1 to FIG. 6 illustrate cross-sectional views of forming a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments. It is understood that the disclosure is not limited by the method described below. Additional operations can be provided before, during, and/or after the method and some of the operations described below can be replaced or eliminated, for additional embodiments of the methods.

(10) Referring to FIG. 1, a substrate **100** is provided. In some embodiments, the substrate **100** is a transparent substrate, such as a glass substrate. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In some embodiments, the substrate **100** has a device layer and a dielectric layer (e.g., silicon oxide layer) formed over the device layer. In such embodiments, the component (e.g., thin film transistor) described below is formed on the dielectric layer over the device layer. In some embodiments, the device layer includes a transistor formed on a semiconductor substrate. The semiconductor substrate includes a bulk semiconductor, a semiconductor-on-insulator (SOI) substrate, or the like, which may be doped (e.g., with a p-type or an n-type dopant) or undoped. The transistor may include a fin field effect transistor (FinFET), a nanostructure FET (nano-FET) (e.g., a nanosheet transistor, a nanowire transistor or a gate-all-around transistor), a planar FET, the like, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the device layer further includes an interconnect structure electrically connected to the transistor, and the dielectric layer is formed over the interconnect structure.

(11) Still referring to FIG. 1, a gate electrode **102** is formed on the substrate **100**. In some embodiments, the gate electrode **102** includes a conductive material, such as Cu, Al, Ti, Ta, W, Ru,

Co, Ni, the like, an alloy thereof, or a combination thereof. Other suitable gate electrode materials are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure. In some embodiments, a barrier layer and/or a seed layer is formed between the gate electrode layer **102** and the substrate **100**. In some embodiments, the barrier layer includes Ti, TiN, Ta, TaN, the like or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the seed layer includes Ti, Cu, Au, Ni, the like, or a combination thereof.

(12) In some embodiments, the gate electrode **102** is formed by depositing a gate electrode material over the substrate with a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD), or the like, and patterning the gate electrode material with photolithography and etching processes. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In some embodiments, the gate electrode **102** is formed by an electroplating process.

(13) Referring to FIG. **1B**, a gate dielectric layer **104** is formed over the substrate **100** and covers the gate electrode **102**. In some embodiments, the gate dielectric layer **104** includes silicon oxide, silicon oxynitride or the like. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In some embodiments, the gate dielectric layer **104** includes a high-k material having a dielectric constant greater than about 4, greater than about 10 or even greater than about 20, such as zirconium dioxide (ZrO₂), aluminum oxide (Al₂O₃), hafnium oxide (HfO₂), tantalum oxide (Ta₂O₅), hafnium silicon oxide (HfSiO), hafnium silicon oxynitride (HfSiON), hafnium tantalum oxide (HfTaO), hafnium titanium oxide (HfTiO), hafnium zirconium oxide (HfZrO), zirconium silicate, zirconium aluminate, titanium oxide, a hafnium dioxide-alumina (HfO₂—Al₂O₃) alloy, the like, or a combination thereof. Other suitable gate dielectric materials are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure. In some embodiments, the gate dielectric layer is a single layer such as a silicon oxide layer or a high-k layer. In other embodiments, the gate dielectric layer **104** has a multi-layer structure (e.g., including a lower silicon oxide layer and an upper high-k layer).

(14) In some embodiments, the method of forming the gate dielectric layer **104** includes performing a suitable deposition process, such as a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD), or the like.

(15) Thereafter, a channel layer **106** is formed over the gate dielectric layer **104**. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** includes a semiconductor material such as a metal oxide material. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** includes at least one element selected from the group consisting In, Ga, Zn, W, Sn, Cd, Al and O. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, indium tungsten oxide (IWO), indium zinc oxide (IZO), indium tin oxide (ITO), indium gallium oxide (IGO), aluminum zinc oxide (AZO), gallium zinc oxide (GZO), gallium oxide (GaO), indium oxide (InO), zinc oxide (ZnO), the like, or a combination thereof, and each of the mentioned materials may be doped or undoped. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** is a single layer such as an IGZO layer. In other embodiments, the channel layer **106** has a multi-layer structure. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, from bottom to top, an IGZO layer and an InO layer. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, from bottom to top, a GZO layer and an InO layer. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, from bottom to top, an IGZO layer and an IZO layer. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, from bottom to top, an IGZO layer and an IGO layer. For example, the channel layer **106** includes, from bottom to top, an InO layer, a GaO layer, a ZnO layer, a GaO layer and an InO layer.

(16) The above embodiments in which the channel layer **106** includes a metal oxide layer are provided for illustration purposes, and are not construed as limiting the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** may include silicon, such as amorphous silicon, microcrystalline silicon or polysilicon. Other suitable channel materials are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure.

(17) In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** is formed by depositing a channel material over

the substrate with a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD), or the like, and patterning the channel material with photolithography and etching processes. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** exposed a portion of the gate dielectric layer **104**.

(18) Still referring to FIG. 2, a dielectric layer **108** is formed over the channel layer **106** and covers the exposed portion of the gate dielectric layer **104**. In some embodiments, the dielectric layer **108** may include an insulating material, such as silicon oxide, silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, aluminum oxide, aluminum nitride, the like, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the dielectric layer includes a low-k material having a dielectric constant less than about 4, less than about 3 or even less. For example, the low-k material includes a polymer containing Si, C, O and/or H, such as methylsiloxane, methylsilsesquioxanes, or an organic and inorganic polymer. For example, the low-k material includes SiCH, SiOCH, carbon-doped oxide (CDO), silicon-oxycarbide, or organosilicate glass (OSG). Other suitable dielectric materials are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure.

(19) In some embodiments, the method of forming the dielectric layer **108** includes performing a suitable deposition process, such as a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD), or the like. A spin-on technique may be applicable.

(20) Referring to FIG. 3, the dielectric layer **108** is patterned to form first and second opening OP1 and OP2 therein. In some embodiments, a mask layer (e.g., a photoresist material or a dielectric mask material) is formed over the dielectric layer **108**, and the dielectric layer **108** is partially removed by using the mask layer as an etching mask. In some embodiments, each of the first and second opening OP1 and OP2 penetrates through the dielectric layer **108** and exposes a portion of the channel layer **106**. Specifically, each of the first and second opening OP1 and OP2 has a stepped bottom (e.g., one-step bottom) exposed by the channel layer **106** and a substantially vertical sidewall exposed by the dielectric layer **108**. In some embodiments, the sidewall of each of the first and second openings OP1 and OP1 may be inclined upon the process requirements.

(21) In some embodiments, the sidewall of each of the first and second openings OP1 and OP2 is aligned with the sidewall of the channel layer **106**, as shown in FIG. 3. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In other embodiments, the sidewall of each of the first and second openings OP1 and OP2 is misaligned with the sidewall of the channel layer **106**. For example, the sidewall of the channel layer **106** extends outwardly from the sidewall of each of the first and second openings OP1 and OP2.

(22) Referring to FIG. 4, a glue layer **110** is formed over the dielectric layer **108** and in the first and second openings OP1 and OP2. In the disclosure, the glue layer **110** is designed to have different growth rates on different materials, so as to improve the adhesion of the subsequently formed source/drain electrodes, but without affecting the resistances of the source/drain electrodes. In some embodiments, since the dielectric layer **108** (e.g. silicon oxide) and the channel layer **106** (e.g., IGZO) are made by different materials, the glue layer **110** are grown with different growth rates. Accordingly, the formed thickness of the glue layer **110** on the dielectric layer **108** (e.g. silicon oxide) is different from the formed thickness of the glue layer **110** on the channel layer **106** (e.g., IGZO).

(23) In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a vertically straight sidewall away from the channel layer **106** and a curved sidewall towards the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a tapered end portion TE towards the top surface of the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, the tapered end portions TE of the glue layer **110** are in “point contact” with the channel layer **106** (marked in dotted regions A and B) while in “surface contact” with the dielectric layer **108**, as shown in FIG. 4. Specifically, the contact area between the glue layer **110** and the dielectric layer **110** is greater than the contact area (almost zero) between the glue layer **110** and the channel layer **106**.

(24) When the precursors and reaction parameters are appropriately selected, the glue layer **110** is selectively formed on the dielectric layer **108**, rather than on the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, when the growth rate of the glue layer **110** formed on the dielectric layer **108** is greater than the growth rate of the glue layer **110** formed on the channel layer **106**, the glue layer **110** is selectively formed on the top surface of the dielectric layer **108** and on the sidewalls of the first and second openings OP1 and OP2 exposed by the dielectric layer **110**. Specifically, the glue layer **110** is selectively formed merely on the dielectric layer **108**, as shown in FIG. 4. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In other embodiments, the glue layer **110** is formed thicker on the dielectric layer **108** while formed thinner on the channel layer **106**.

(25) In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** includes WCN, WN or the like, and such material exhibit different growth rates for different materials. In some embodiments, the precursors of the glue layer **110** include a tungsten-containing precursor **200** and a nitrogen-containing precursor **300**, as shown in FIG. 7.

(26) In some embodiments, the nitrogen-containing precursor **300** includes, for example but not limited thereto, NH₃ or N₂. Other suitable nitrogen-containing precursors are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure.

(27) In some embodiments, the tungsten-containing precursor includes: bis(tert-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(iso-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(neo-pentylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(isopropylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(cyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), or bis(methylcyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI).

(28) Other suitable tungsten-containing precursors are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure.

(29) FIG. 7 is a graph of sequence of pulses of different precursors in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the method of forming glue layer **110** includes introducing first pulses **202** of a tungsten-containing precursor **200** and second pulses **302** of a nitrogen-containing precursor **300** into the same process chamber (e.g., ALD chamber). In some embodiments, the first pulses **202** of the tungsten-containing precursor **200** are not overlapped with the second pulses **302** of the nitrogen-containing precursor **300**. Specifically, the first pulses **202** of the tungsten-containing precursor **200** and the second pulses **302** of the nitrogen-containing precursor **300** are introduced into the process chamber alternately. However, the disclosure is not limited thereto. In other embodiments, the first pulses **202** of the tungsten-containing precursor **200** may be partially overlapped with the second pulses **302** of the nitrogen-containing precursor **300**. In some embodiments, the process temperature ranges from about 350° C. to 450° C., and the chamber pressure ranges from about 3 torr to 30 torr. In some embodiments, a dilute gas such as an inert gas (e.g., argon) may be introduced to the process chamber during the operation of forming the glue layer **110**. In some embodiments, a hydrogen-containing gas (e.g., H₂) may be introduced to the process chamber during the operation of forming the glue layer **110** upon the process requirements.

(30) The above embodiments in which the glue layer **110** is formed with an atomic layer deposition (ALD) process are provided for illustration purposes, and are not construed as limiting present disclosure. In other embodiments, the glue layer **110** is formed with a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, or the like.

(31) Referring to FIG. 5, a metal layer **111** is formed over the glue layer **110** and filled into the first and second openings OP1 and OP2. In some embodiments, the metal layer **111** includes a conductive material, such as Cu, Al, Ti, Ta, W, Ru, Co, Ni, the like, an alloy thereof, or a combination thereof. Other suitable metal materials for source and drain electrodes are within the contemplated scope of the disclosure. In some embodiments, a barrier layer and/or a seed layer is

formed between the metal layer **111** and the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, the barrier layer includes Ti, TiN, Ta, TaN, the like or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the seed layer includes Ti, Cu, Au, Ni, the like, or a combination thereof.

(32) In some embodiments, the method of forming the metal layer **111** includes performing a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a plasma enhanced CVD (PECVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD), or the like.

(33) Referring to FIG. **6**, a planarization process is performed to the metal layer **111** and the glue layer **110**, so as to remove the excess materials outside of the first and second openings OP1 and OP2. In some embodiments, a portion of the metal layer **111** and a portion of the glue layer **110** are removed with a planarization process, such as a chemical mechanical polishing (CMP) process. The remaining metal layer **111** forms a metal pattern **112** in the first opening OP1 and a metal pattern **114** in the second opening OP2. In some embodiments, the metal pattern **112** is referred to as a source electrode, and the metal pattern **114** is referred to as a drain electrode in some examples. The terms of “metal patterns” and “source/drain electrodes” may exchangedly use through the specification. The glue layer **110** is regarded as part of the source and drain regions in some examples. Upon the CMP process, the tops of the glue layer **110**, the source electrode **112** and the drain electrode **114** are substantially coplanar or flushed with each other. A semiconductor device **1** of some embodiments is thus completed. The semiconductor device **1** is referred to as a “thin film transistor (TFT)” in some examples.

(34) In the semiconductor device **1**, the source electrode **112** and the drain electrode **114** are in physical contact with the underlying channel layer **106**, so that the contact resistance (R_c) delay of the source electrode **112** and the drain electrode **114** are improved, and thus, the performance of the device is accordingly improved.

(35) The semiconductor device **1** of FIG. **6** may be modified to have other configurations, as shown in FIG. **8** to FIG. **10**. Each of the semiconductor devices in FIG. **8** to FIG. **10** may be similar to the semiconductor device **1** in FIG. **6**, with similar features of the semiconductor devices being labeled with similar numerical references and descriptions of the similar features are not repeated herein.

(36) The semiconductor device **2** of FIG. **8** may be similar to the semiconductor device **1** of FIG. **6**, and the difference between them lies in the configuration of the glue layer **110**. In the semiconductor device **1** of FIG. **6**, the glue layer **110** is merely formed on the dielectric layer **108**, as shown in FIG. **6**. In the semiconductor device **2** of FIG. **8**, the glue layer **110** may be formed thicker on the dielectric layer **108** but formed thinner on the channel layer **106**. For example, the glue layer **110** has a first thickness TH1 on the dielectric layer **108** and a second thickness TH2 on the channel layer **106**. For example, the first thickness TH1 of the glue layer **110** (including the tapered end portion) ranges from about 1 angstrom to 200 angstroms (e.g., 20 angstrom to 100 angstroms), and the second thickness TH2 of the glue layer **110** ranges from about 1 to 5 angstroms (e.g., 2 angstrom to 3 angstroms). The second thickness TH2 is such thin, without affecting the resistances of the subsequently formed source/drain electrodes.

(37) In some embodiments, the ratio of the first thickness TH1 to the second thickness TH2 ranges from about 20:1 to 100:1, such as 50:1. In some embodiments, the ratio of the first thickness TH1 to the second thickness TH2 can be, for example but is not limited to, about 30:1, 40:1, 50:1, 60:1, 70:1, 80:1, 90:1, including any range between any two of the preceding values and any range more than any one of the preceding values. In some embodiments, the ratio of the first thickness TH1 to the second thickness TH2 is such as to improve the properties of the source/drain regions.

(38) The semiconductor device **3** of FIG. **9** may be similar to the semiconductor device **1** of FIG. **6**, and the difference between them lies in the shapes of the glue layer **110** and the source and drain electrodes **112** and **114**. In the semiconductor device **1** of FIG. **6**, the source and drain electrodes **112** and **114** are merely in contact with the channel layer **106**, and each of the source and drain electrodes **112** and **114** has a stepped bottom (e.g., one-step bottom), as shown in FIG. **6**. In the semiconductor device **3** of FIG. **9**, the source and drain electrodes **112** and **114** are in contact with

the channel layer **106** and the gate dielectric layer **104**, and each of the source and drain electrodes **112** and **114** has a stepped bottom (e.g., two-step bottom). The method of forming the semiconductor device **3** is similar to operations described in FIG. **1** to FIG. **6**, except that during the operation of forming first and second openings OP1 and OP2 in FIG. **3**, the first and second openings OP1 and OP2 further expose a portion of the gate dielectric layer **104**.

(39) The growth rate of the glue layer **110** formed on the dielectric layer **108** is similar to the growth rate of the glue layer **110** formed on the gate dielectric layer **104**, but different from the growth rate of the glue layer **110** formed on the channel layer **106**. Accordingly, the glue layer **110** is selectively formed on the dielectric layer **108** and the gate dielectric layer **104**, rather than on the channel layer **106**.

(40) In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a vertically straight sidewall away from the channel layer **106** and a curved sidewall towards the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a tapered end portion TE towards the sidewall of the channel layer **106**. In some embodiments, the tapered end portions TE of the glue layer **110** are in “point contact” with the channel layer **106** (marked in dotted regions A and B) while in “surface contact” with the dielectric layer **108** and the gate dielectric layer **104**, as shown in FIG. **8**. Specifically, the contact area between the glue layer **110** and each of the dielectric layer **108** and the gate dielectric layer **104** is greater than the contact area (almost zero) between the glue layer **110** and the channel layer **106**.

(41) The semiconductor device **4** of FIG. **10** may be similar to the semiconductor device **3** of FIG. **9**, and the difference between them lies in the configuration of the glue layer **110**. In the semiconductor device **2** of FIG. **8**, the glue layer **110** is formed on the dielectric layer **108** and the gate dielectric layer **104**, as shown in FIG. **8**. In the semiconductor device **4** of FIG. **10**, the glue layer **110** may be formed thicker on the dielectric layer **108** and the gate dielectric layer **104** but formed thinner on the channel layer **106**. For example, the glue layer **110** has a first thickness TH1 on the dielectric layer **108** and a second thickness TH2 on the channel layer. In some embodiments, the ratio of the first thickness TH1 to the second thickness TH2 ranges from about 20:1 to 100:1, such as 50:1. For example, the first thickness TH1 of the glue layer **110** (including the tapered end portion) ranges from about 1 angstrom to 200 angstroms (e.g., 20 angstrom to 100 angstroms), and the second thickness TH2 of the glue layer **110** ranges from about 1 to 5 angstroms (e.g., 2 angstrom to 3 angstroms).

(42) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a semiconductor device **1/2/3/4** includes a substrate **100**, a gate electrode **102**, a gate dielectric layer **104**, a channel layer **106**, a source electrode and a drain electrode. The gate electrode **102** is disposed over the substrate **100**. The gate dielectric layer **104** is disposed over the gate electrode **102**. The channel layer **106** is disposed over the gate dielectric layer **104**. The source electrode and the drain electrode are disposed over the channel layer **106** and beside the gate electrode **102**. In some embodiments, the source electrode includes a glue layer **110** and a metal pattern **112**, and the drain electrode includes a glue layer **110** and a metal pattern **114**. In some embodiments, a thickness of the glue layer **110** adjacent to a sidewall of the metal pattern **112/114** is greater than a thickness of the glue layer **110** adjacent to a bottom of the metal pattern **112/114**.

(43) In some embodiments, the thickness of the glue layer **110** adjacent to the sidewall of the metal pattern **112/114** is greater than the thickness of the glue layer **110** adjacent to the bottom of the metal pattern **112/114**, as shown in FIG. **6** and FIGS. **8-10**. In some embodiments, the thickness of the glue layer **110** adjacent to the bottom of the metal pattern **112/114** is approximately zero, as shown in FIG. **6** and FIG. **9**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a tapered end portion TE. In some embodiments, the metal pattern **112/114** is in contact with the channel layer **106**, as shown in FIG. **6** and FIGS. **8-10**. In some embodiments, the metal pattern **112/114** is in contact with the channel layer **106** and the gate dielectric layer **104**, as shown in FIG. **8** and FIG. **10**. In some embodiments, a thickness of the glue layer **110** on the channel layer **106** is different from a thickness of the glue layer **110** on the gate dielectric layer **104**. In some embodiments, the thickness

of the glue layer **110** on the channel layer **106** is less than the thickness of the glue layer on the gate dielectric layer **104**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** includes WCN, WN or a combination thereof.

(44) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a semiconductor device **1/2/3/4** includes a substrate **100**, a gate electrode **102**, a gate dielectric layer **104**, a channel layer **106**, a source electrode and a drain electrode. The gate electrode **102** is disposed over the substrate **100**. The gate dielectric layer **104** is disposed over the gate electrode **102**. The channel layer **106** is disposed over the gate dielectric layer **104**. The source electrode and the drain electrode are disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode includes a glue layer and a metal pattern, and the glue layer includes WCN, WN or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, each of the source electrode and the drain electrode is free of titanium nitride (TiN).

(45) In some embodiments, the semiconductor device **1/2/3/4** further includes a dielectric layer **108** aside the source electrode and the drain electrode, wherein the metal pattern **112/114** is in contact with the channel layer **106** while separated from the dielectric layer **108**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** is further disposed between the gate dielectric layer **104** and the metal pattern **112/114**. In some embodiments, the glue layer **110** has a tapered end portion TE. In some embodiments, the channel layer **106** includes at least one element selected from the group consisting In, Ga, Zn, W, Sn, Cd, Al and O.

(46) A glue layer is contemplated as falling within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, as long as such glue layer improves the adhesion of the subsequently formed source/drain electrodes, but without affecting the resistances of the source/drain electrodes.

(47) FIG. **11** illustrates a method of forming a semiconductor device in accordance with some embodiments. Although the method is illustrated and/or described as a series of acts or events, it will be appreciated that the method is not limited to the illustrated ordering or acts. Thus, in some embodiments, the acts may be carried out in different orders than illustrated, and/or may be carried out concurrently. Further, in some embodiments, the illustrated acts or events may be subdivided into multiple acts or events, which may be carried out at separate times or concurrently with other acts or sub-acts. In some embodiments, some illustrated acts or events may be omitted, and other un-illustrated acts or events may be included.

(48) At act **400**, a substrate is provided. FIG. **1** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **400**.

(49) At act **402**, a gate electrode is formed over the substrate. FIG. **1** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **402**.

(50) At act **404**, a gate dielectric layer is formed over the gate electrode. FIG. **2** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **404**.

(51) At act **406**, a channel layer is formed over the gate dielectric layer. FIG. **2** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **406**.

(52) At act **408**, a dielectric layer is formed over the channel layer. FIG. **2** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **408**.

(53) At act **410**, the dielectric layer is patterned to form first and second openings that expose a portion of the dielectric layer and a portion of the channel layer. FIG. **3** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **410**.

(54) At act **412**, a glue layer is formed in each the first and second openings, wherein a growth rate of the glue layer formed on the dielectric layer is different from a growth rate of the glue layer formed on the channel layer. FIG. **4** illustrates a cross-sectional view corresponding to some embodiments of act **412**. In some embodiments, the glue layer is merely formed on the dielectric layer. In other embodiments, the glue layer is formed thicker on the dielectric layer while formed thinner on the channel layer.

(55) In some embodiments, precursors of forming the glue layer include a tungsten-containing

precursor and a nitrogen-containing precursor.

(56) In some embodiments, the nitrogen-containing precursor includes NH.sub.3 or N.sub.2. In some embodiments, the tungsten-containing precursor includes: bis(tert-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(iso-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(neo-pentylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(isopropylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), bis(cyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI), or bis(methylcyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino)tungsten(VI).

(57) At act 414, a metal pattern is formed in each of the first and second openings. FIG. 5 to FIG. 6 illustrate cross-sectional views corresponding to some embodiments of act 414.

(58) In the disclosure, the glue layers of source and drain electrodes are selectively formed on sidewalls of the source and drain electrodes, with the minimum amount (even zero) on bottoms of the source and drain electrodes, so as to reduce the contact resistance (R_c) delay and therefore improve the performance of the device.

(59) Many variations of the above examples are contemplated by the present disclosure. It is understood that different embodiments may have different advantages, and that no particular advantage is necessarily required of all embodiments.

(60) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a semiconductor device includes a substrate, a gate electrode, a gate dielectric layer, a channel layer, a source electrode and a drain electrode. The gate electrode is disposed over the substrate. The gate dielectric layer is disposed over the gate electrode. The channel layer is disposed over the gate dielectric layer. The source electrode and the drain electrode are disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode. In some embodiments, each of the source electrode and the drain electrode includes a glue layer and a metal pattern, and a thickness of the glue layer adjacent to a sidewall of the metal pattern is greater than a thickness of the glue layer adjacent to a bottom of the metal pattern.

(61) In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a semiconductor device includes a substrate, a gate electrode, a gate dielectric layer, a channel layer, a source electrode and a drain electrode. The gate electrode is disposed over the substrate. The gate dielectric layer is disposed over the gate electrode. The channel layer is disposed over the gate dielectric layer. The source electrode and the drain electrode are disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode includes a glue layer and a metal pattern, and the glue layer includes WCN, WN or a combination thereof. In accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure, a method of forming a semiconductor device includes following operations. A substrate is provided. A gate electrode is formed over a substrate. A gate dielectric layer is formed over the gate electrode. A channel layer is formed over the gate dielectric layer. A dielectric layer is formed over the channel layer. The dielectric layer is patterned to form first and second openings that expose a portion of the dielectric layer and a portion of the channel layer. A glue layer is formed in each the first and second openings, wherein a growth rate of the glue layer formed on the dielectric layer is different from a growth rate of the glue layer formed on the channel layer. A metal pattern is formed in each of the first and second openings.

(62) The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A semiconductor device, comprising: a substrate; a gate electrode disposed over the substrate; a gate dielectric layer disposed over the gate electrode; a channel layer disposed over the gate dielectric layer; and a source electrode and a drain electrode disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode comprises a glue layer and a metal pattern, wherein a thickness of the glue layer includes a variable thickness between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer, and the thickness of the glue layer is a minimum distance between an inner surface of the glue layer and an outer surface of the glue layer, and wherein the glue layer between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer has a tapered thickness towards the channel layer.
2. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode has an uneven bottom.
3. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode has a stepped bottom.
4. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the channel layer comprises at least one element selected from the group consisting of In, Ga, Zn, W, Sn, Cd, Al and O.
5. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the metal pattern is separated from the channel layer.
6. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the glue layer is further disposed between the metal pattern and each of the channel layer and the gate dielectric layer.
7. The semiconductor device of claim 6, wherein a thickness of the glue layer on the channel layer is different from the thickness of the glue layer on the gate dielectric layer.
8. The semiconductor device of claim 7, wherein the thickness of the glue layer on the channel layer is less than the thickness of the glue layer on the gate dielectric layer.
9. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the glue layer comprises WCN, WN or a combination thereof.
10. A semiconductor device, comprising: a substrate; a gate electrode disposed over the substrate; a gate dielectric layer disposed over the gate electrode; a channel layer disposed over the gate dielectric layer; a source electrode and a drain electrode disposed over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode comprises a glue layer and a metal pattern, and the glue layer is a tungsten-containing material, wherein a thickness of the glue layer includes a variable thickness between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer, and the thickness of the glue layer is a minimum distance between an inner surface of the glue layer and an outer surface of the glue layer, and wherein the glue layer between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer has a tapered thickness towards the channel layer.
11. The semiconductor device of claim 10, further comprising a dielectric layer aside the source electrode and the drain electrode, wherein the metal pattern is separated from both the channel layer and the dielectric layer.
12. The semiconductor device of claim 10, wherein the glue layer is further disposed between the channel layer and the metal pattern.
13. The semiconductor device of claim 10, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode has an uneven bottom.
14. The semiconductor device of claim 10, wherein the channel layer comprises at least one element selected from the group consisting of In, Ga, Zn, W, Sn, Cd, Al and O.
15. A method of forming a semiconductor device, comprising: providing a substrate; forming a gate electrode over a substrate; forming a gate dielectric layer over the gate electrode; forming a channel layer over the gate dielectric layer; and forming a source electrode and a drain electrode over the channel layer and beside the gate electrode, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain

electrode comprises a glue layer and a metal pattern, wherein a thickness of the glue layer includes a variable thickness between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer, and the thickness of the glue layer is a minimum distance between an inner surface of the glue layer and an outer surface of the glue layer, and wherein the glue layer between the metal pattern and the gate dielectric layer has a tapered thickness towards the channel layer.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the glue layer comprises WCN, WN or a combination thereof.

17. The method of claim 15, wherein each of the source electrode and the drain electrode has an uneven bottom.

18. The method of claim 15, wherein precursors of forming the glue layer comprise a tungsten-containing precursor and a nitrogen-containing precursor.

19. The method of claim 18, wherein the tungsten-containing precursor comprises: bis(tert-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI), bis(iso-butylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI), bis(neo-pentylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI), bis(isopropylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI), bis(cyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI), or bis(methylcyclopentadienylimino)bis(dimethylamino) tungsten(VI).

20. The method of claim 18, wherein the nitrogen-containing precursor comprises NH_3 or N_2 .
